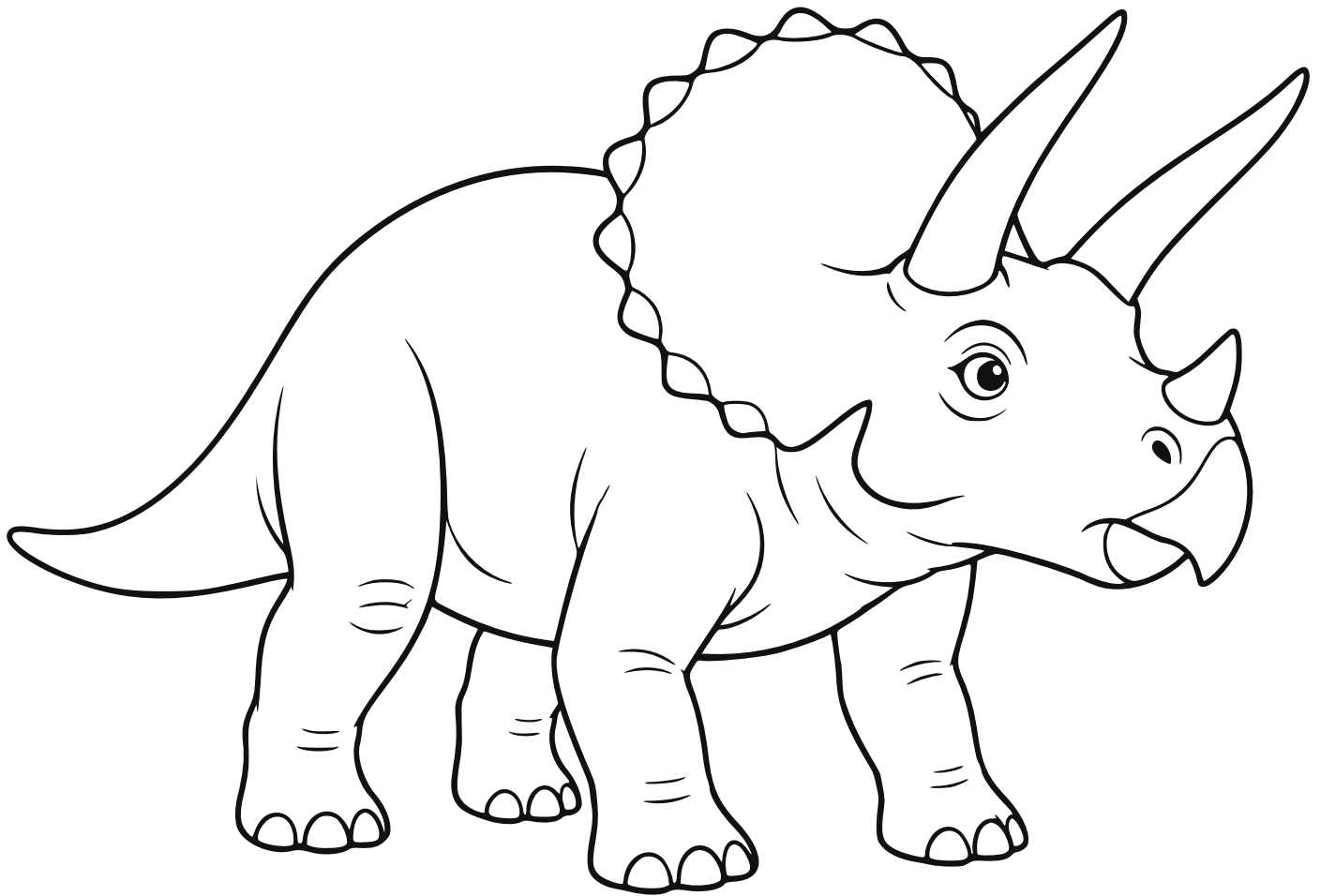


# Hello, Triceratops!

Want to color Triceratops, or roll a dough loop for it?



**T**

## Triceratops

**Say it:** try-SAIR-uh-tops · **Ate:** plants

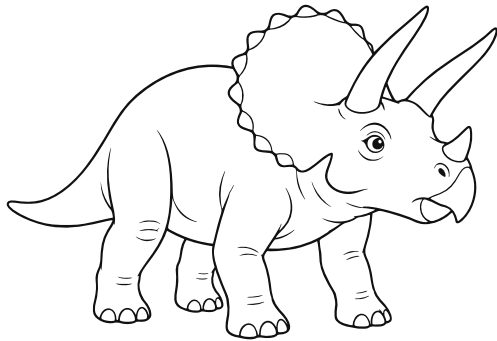
**Lived:** Late Cretaceous · **Wow:** Triceratops had three horns and a frill.

**Alex decides:** Which spoken word starts with /t/: sock or towel?

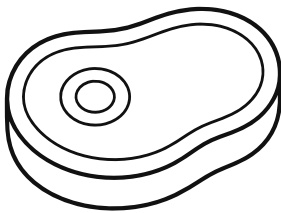
**If they want more:** If that sound game is easy, try a fresh spoken pair: sun or tap.

# Dinner for Triceratops

Want to squash a leafy dinner, or build Triceratops a pen?



4



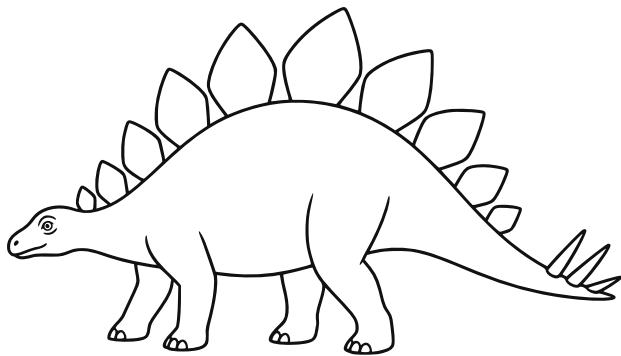
Grown-up: use playdough for pretend food on a washable mat or sheet protector.  
The blank plate has no counting slots. Food pictures are symbols; keep them on the page.

**Alex decides:** Which food belongs to Triceratops, and when are four leaves enough?

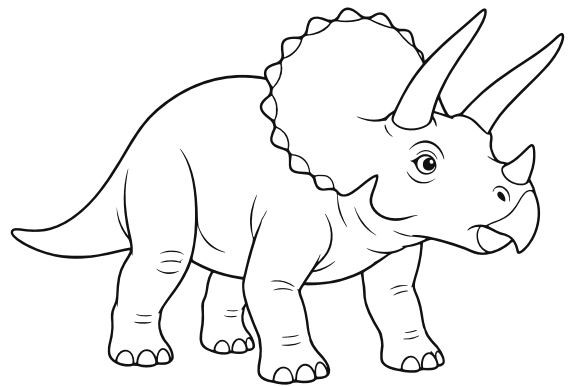
**If they want more:** Clear the plate, return all eight leaves, and invite five if four was easy.

## Who ate something different?

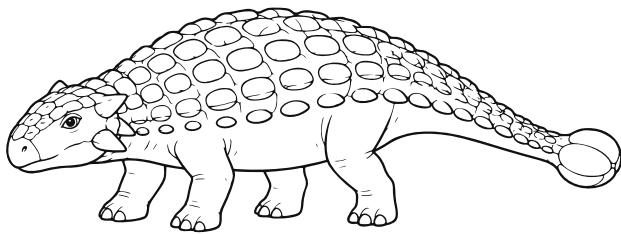
Want to tell a dinosaur dinner story, or hide a picture after the story?



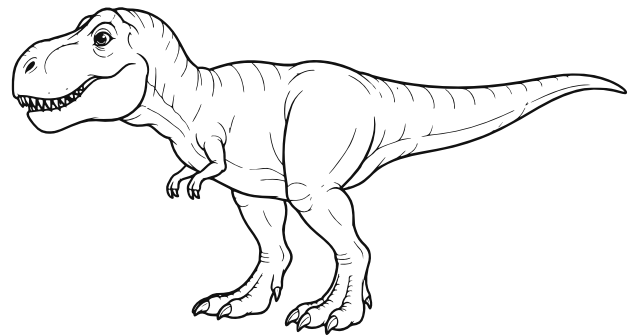
ALEX



ALEX



ALEX



ALEX

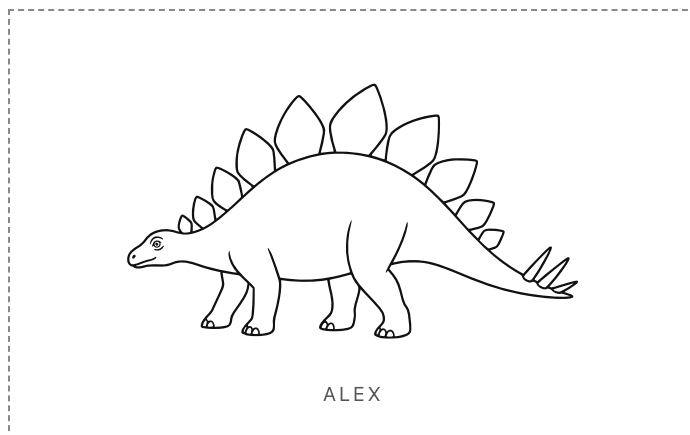
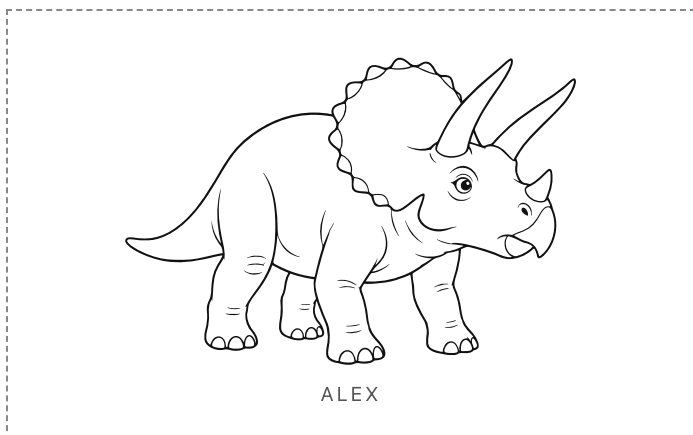
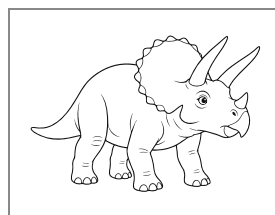
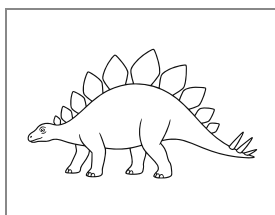
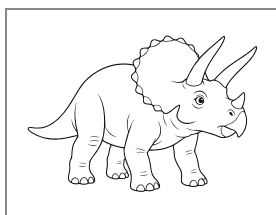
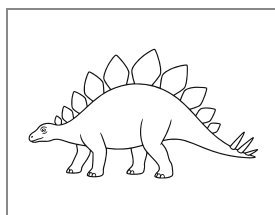
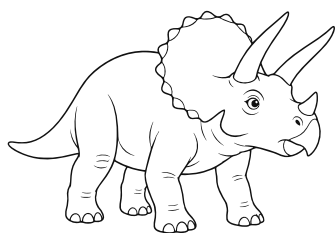
Grown-up: share the dinner story on the card first. Cut and shuffle these pictures for a later choice.  
These dinosaurs are a comparison set, not a scene of animals living together.

**Alex decides:** Which dinosaur ate meat instead of plants?

**If they want more:** Invite the hidden dinosaur's name and food before uncovering it.

# What comes next?

Want to build a tile trail, or choose the next picture?



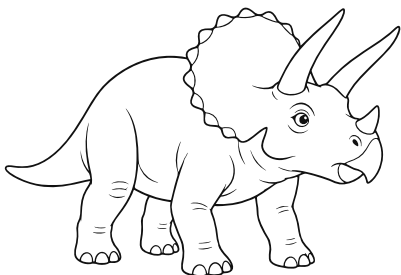
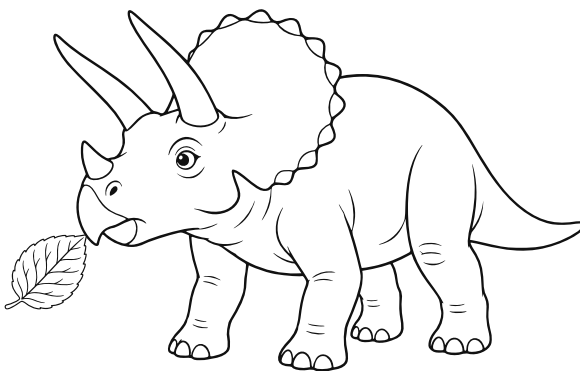
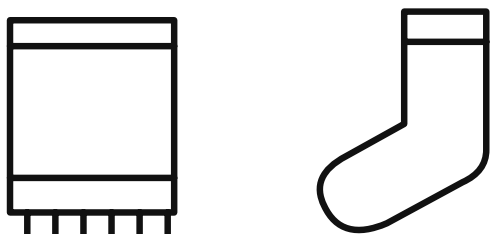
Grown-up: keep the row whole. Cut the two choice cards and shuffle them.  
Point to a choice or put it below the blank; the cards are deliberately larger than the boxes.

**Alex decides:** Which picture continues the Stegosaurus–Triceratops pattern?

**If they want more:** After their first tile choice, offer one more place, with both colors available again.

# A book for Triceratops

Want to turn the pages while I read, or make a dough resting place first?

|                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>1</p>  <p>Triceratops</p> <p>T</p> <p>ALEX</p>              | <p>2</p>  <p>It eats plants.</p> <p>ALEX</p>         |
| <p>3</p> <p>T</p>  <p>Which starts with /t/?</p> <p>ALEX</p> | <p>4</p>  <p>A round resting place</p> <p>ALEX</p> |

Grown-up: cut four pages and stack 1–4; a clip or ring is fine. Read the captions aloud.  
Last page: a pretend resting place for a dough loop or a crayon circle. No reading expected from Alex.

**Alex decides:** Which picture word starts with /t/: towel or sock?

**If they want more:** Cover the pictures and invite the sound for T, if they want another turn.

MONDAY • ALEX • 2–10 MIN

## Hello, Triceratops!

**Set out:** The coloring page, crayons and scrap paper; a little dough on a washable mat.

**Say:** “Want to color Triceratops, or roll a dough loop for it?”

Share the dinosaur strip as you play. Let them color or join the ends of a dough snake. A free crayon circle on scrap is welcome too. For a sound turn, say “sock” and “towel” naturally; ask which starts with /t/. If the words or game are new, show one together first. Point to T and model /t/; an echo is welcome. If they want a repeat, reverse the spoken word order.

**Say it:** try-SAIR-uh-tops • **Ate:** plants

**Lived:** Late Cretaceous • **Wow:** Triceratops had three horns and a frill.

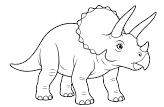
**Alex decides:** Which spoken word starts with /t/: sock or towel?

**If they want more:** If that sound game is easy, try a fresh spoken pair: sun or tap.

**Optional note:** Which word did they choose for /t/?

### YOU'LL NEED

Page, card, crayons, scrap paper, playdough, washable mat; parent present.



TUESDAY • ALEX • 2–10 MIN

## Dinner for Triceratops

**Set out:** The page in a protector, dough and eight magnet tiles. Use its printed dinosaur as the pen marker.

**Say:** “Want to squash a leafy dinner, or build Triceratops a pen?”

Share that Triceratops ate plants. Make eight pretend dough leaves together. If they build the pen first, make the eight leaves while they build. Later, offer the leaf/meat pictures: which is its food? Put all eight leaves together off the plate and ask for four on it. Let them decide when to stop; no numeral reading needed.

**Alex decides:** Which food belongs to Triceratops, and when are four leaves enough?

**If they want more:** Clear the plate, return all eight leaves, and invite five if four was easy.

**Optional note:** Did they stop at four leaves?

### YOU'LL NEED

Page, card, protector or washable mat, dough for eight leaves, eight magnet tiles; parent present.



WEDNESDAY · ALEX · 2–10 MIN

## Who ate something different?

**Set out:** Four dinosaur pictures and a cloth. Key before cutting: top left Stegosaurus; top right Triceratops; bottom left Ankylosaurus; bottom right T. rex.

**Say:** “Want to tell a dinosaur dinner story, or hide a picture after the story?”

First tell their dinner story: Stegosaurus, Triceratops and Ankylosaurus ate plants; T. rex ate meat. Put this card aside and play with the pictures awhile. Later, shuffle and ask who ate meat. If they pick another difference, listen to their reason, then return to the food question. For hiding, name the four together; cover one while they look away and invite them to guess.

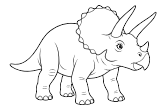
**Alex decides:** Which dinosaur ate meat instead of plants?

**If they want more:** Invite the hidden dinosaur’s name and food before uncovering it.

**Optional note:** Which dinosaur did they pick, and what did they say about its food?

### YOU'LL NEED

Page, card, scissors and cloth; parent present.



THURSDAY · ALEX · 2–10 MIN

## What comes next?

**Set out:** Four red and four blue magnet tiles (any two colors work). Cut the two picture choices; keep the row whole.

**Say:** “Want to build a tile trail, or choose the next picture?”

Show red–blue–red–blue and add red together. Take it all apart. Then lay blue–red–blue–red; offer one tile of each color for the next place. Or name the printed row together, leaving its blank for Alex. Keep both picture choices available; they can point or park a card below the blank. One route is enough.

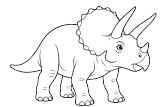
**Alex decides:** Which picture continues the Stegosaurus–Triceratops pattern?

**If they want more:** After their first tile choice, offer one more place, with both colors available again.

**Optional note:** What did they choose to come next?

### YOU'LL NEED

Page, card, scissors, eight magnet tiles (four each of two colors); parent present.



FRIDAY · ALEX · 2–10 MIN

## A book for Triceratops

**Set out:** Cut the four panels and stack 1–4. Set out dough, a mat, crayons and scrap paper.

**Say:** “Want to turn the pages while I read, or make a dough resting place first?”

Read the captions as they turn pages; they are not expected to read them. Talk about the dinosaur eating plants. Name “towel” and “sock” naturally before asking which starts with /t/. Show T and model the sound. On the last page, they can join a dough snake into a resting loop, or make their own crayon circle on scrap. No need to do every part. If they want a repeat, reverse the spoken word order.

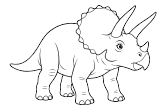
**Alex decides:** Which picture word starts with /t/: towel or sock?

**If they want more:** Cover the pictures and invite the sound for T, if they want another turn.

**Optional note:** Did they make a crayon circle with the ends meeting?

### YOU'LL NEED

Page, card, scissors, optional clip/ring, playdough, washable mat, crayons, scrap paper; parent present.



ALEX · GROWN-UP CARD

## A little play is plenty.

Set it out and play nearby. Each card offers two ways in; they can say no to both. Choose one short route, not every suggestion. Stop on pushback and save it for another day.

Stay with them for 2–10 minutes of floor play. Playdough, magnet tiles, Lego, crayons, cut cards, clips and rings are fine. Adult cuts the printed pieces. Use scrap paper for free circles; no tracing or pencil work.

Print US Letter, actual size (100%), headers/footers off. Pages 1–5 are play pages; 6–8 hold these cards. The daily card explains any cutting. Keep the card beside you, outside their puzzle choices.

Books and songs are a basket to choose from, not homework. One book and one roar count. If you feel like jotting something down afterward, the question on each card is enough.